

RX-BIO-RA-v6: Biologic DMARDs for Rheumatoid Arthritis

Evercare Plan Medical Policy

Policy Number: RX-BIO-RA-v6

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

SCOPE: Biologic disease-modifying antirheumatic drugs (DMARDs) for rheumatoid arthritis.

MEDICAL NECESSITY CRITERIA. All of the following must be met:

1. Confirmed diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis documented by a rheumatologist.
2. Moderate or severe disease activity (DAS28 at or above 3.2, or equivalent measure).
3. Step therapy: documented trial of at least one conventional DMARD at adequate dose and duration (generally 12 weeks), OR documented intolerance or contraindication to conventional DMARDs. Methotrexate is the preferred first-line agent; an inadequate response to methotrexate 15-25mg weekly for at least 12 weeks satisfies the step requirement. Intolerance is defined as a clinically significant adverse event requiring discontinuation (e.g., hepatotoxicity, cytopenia, persistent GI intolerance).
4. No active serious infection, no latent tuberculosis untreated, no active malignancy.